

Increase Neck Size with 4 Steps - 1STMAN

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Executive Summary

The creator shares the four-step approach that grew his neck from roughly 16 inches to ~19–20 inches: compound lifts plus a caloric surplus, targeted neck isolation exercises, boxing-style neck training, and trap development — with a warning to progress carefully.

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Step 1: Lift Heavy & Eat More Calories 1:16

- The foundation is a caloric surplus combined with heavy lifting — without it, neck growth stalls regardless of isolation work.
- Studies cited: doing only compound lifts with zero neck-specific exercises results in **0% neck gains**.
 - Simply deadlifting does create neck strain, but does not specifically target neck muscles enough to drive growth.
- However, certain compound movements do secondarily engage the neck and are worth prioritising:
 - Front raises
 - Lateral raises
 - Seated overhead press — because sitting at a 90° angle forces the neck to stabilise and hold upright throughout the lift
 - Flies
 - Pull-ups — noted as surprisingly effective at straining the neck
- The mechanism: as total bodyweight and muscle mass increase with a caloric surplus, muscle distributes around the whole body, including the neck — but only if the exercises call upon neck muscles.
- Takeaway: don't rely on squats and bench press alone; incorporate movements that demand neck stabilisation.

Step 2: Neck Isolation Exercises 3:10

- Dedicated neck isolation exercises are described as **essential for every man** and credited as a major driver of the creator's neck size increase.
- The neck and submental zone are packed with multiple overlapping triangles of muscles that almost nobody ever targets — this means beginners get rapid "beginner gains" and can add a couple of inches relatively quickly.
- **The king of neck exercises** (creator's personal pick): a lying head raise where you tilt your head back, then raise it back up and drive the chin hard into the chest, holding the contracted position for a moment.
 - The chin-to-chest drive at the top is the key technique cue for maximum muscle engagement.
 - Begin with one hand cupped behind the head for support and safety.
 - Progress to adding weight: hold a weight plate on the forehead with your hands.
 - Can also be done laterally — lying on your side and raising the neck upward to work the sides.
 - Can be performed hanging off the end of a bed, sofa, or bench press — no gym required.
- The submental zone (under the chin/jaw) is specifically called out as a neglected area that responds well to direct training.
- Safety warnings:
 - Do not overstrain; neck injuries are a real risk.
 - Start without weight; add resistance only once you have built a solid base of strength.
 - All exercises done at the viewer's own risk.

Step 3: Boxing-Style Neck Training 5:27

- Advanced boxing and wrestling neck exercises used by elite athletes are highlighted as highly effective for building a thick, masculine-looking neck.
- Examples mentioned:
 - **Anthony Joshua** — holds a towel in his mouth and pulls up kettlebells; described as "extreme level" — trains this way because he needs to absorb punches.
 - **Mike Tyson** — wrestling bridges (lying and bridging up on the top of the head/neck).
 - **Floyd Mayweather** — used a head harness device, hanging off the canvas and raising his head to strain and build the neck.
- These exercises carry **significant injury risk** and are categorised as for more advanced/elite trainees only.
 - The creator recommends avoiding them for at least the first 6 months of neck training.
 - He himself only incorporated them after roughly 6–8 months of consistent neck training.
 - His prior neck strength from years of weight training and playing football (where heading the ball is common) gave him a base — complete beginners are at higher risk.
- Creator's current status: now strong enough to hold a towel in his mouth, attach it to weights, and lift — and is considering adding wrestling bridges to his routine.
- Progression rule: stick to bodyweight neck isolation for the first 6 months, then introduce weighted exercises and boxing-style movements gradually.

Step 4: Grow Your Traps 7:44

- The traps are directly connected to the neck; building both together creates a visually unified, padded, dominant upper frame.
- A big neck with flat traps still looks incomplete — described as "a long neck with nothing connected."
- A big neck combined with developed traps creates what the creator calls a "platform of stability" — a broad, powerful-looking shoulder and neck complex that also improves the appearance of the jawline.
- **Shrugs** are the go-to exercise:
 - Engage both the traps and the neck simultaneously.
 - Grip width matters: a **wider grip** produces better stretch and strain across the trap/neck area and builds more muscle than a narrow grip.
- The combined effect of neck + traps is described as immediately improving first impressions and projecting physical dominance.

Wrap-Up & Key Takeaways 8:53

- Creator's self-reported result: neck grew approximately **4–5 inches** (from ~16 in to ~19–20 in) by consistently applying all four steps.
 - Currently at roughly 19–19.5 inches while in a cutting phase (close to six-pack condition), so anticipates the neck will look even more angular and defined as body fat drops.
- Plans to increase boxing training volume going forward, including potentially adding wrestling bridges.
- The neck is compared to the glutes — a critically neglected muscle group that men rarely train, but that delivers outsized aesthetic returns when targeted.

"There's these disregarded areas of the body that when you bring them all together, you become a superhero. Like, everything blends together and you just look fantastic."

- Summary of the four steps in order:
 - Heavy compound lifts + caloric surplus (including overhead press, pull-ups, lateral/front raises)
 - Neck isolation exercises (head raises with chin drive, progressing to weighted)
 - Boxing/wrestling neck exercises (for advanced trainees only, after 6+ months of base training)
 - Trap development via wide-grip shrugs
- Creator also sells a men's lifestyle supplement and a Male Advantage ebook (links in bio).